

D'Esposito: "We had to put actors in a suit that had heroic proportions that don't really fit many human beings. So how do we get around that? How do we get the reality of the suit on the set, but still make it comfortable for our actors and/or stunt people to wear? We said, 'Listen, let's lose the legs because the movement's not working, and we're going to have to recreate that anyway.' We get the movement of the actor or stunt person; we're tracking their movement—it's almost like being in a motion capture stage—and we're getting the reality of the suit on the torso."

Mahan: "An illustrator has to understand, you have to make it fit the anatomy of a person. You can't cheat the proportions and you can't cheat perspective to hide something. Everything's going to be visible. So finally the maquette, from the waist up, Robert Downey fits in that. The other proportions are correct, and once we designed that and built that, then the digital companies could take that physical, full-size piece, scan that one and use that as the basis for their computer model. They would obviously tweak it a little bit more, like take the waist in—just subtle little changes—maybe make the arms a little longer. But you really are hard-pressed to determine which one is which."